The State's three forms

Deleuze and Guattari distinguish "three major forms" of the State (459). In fact, they are not stages, since each form is in "resonance" with the others, and all of them "exhibit a unity of composition in spite of their differences in organization and development" (459). The sheet opens the single column that *The five machinic processes* gives to capture. Brackets join the forms where Deleuze and Guattari set out a relation between them.

Question	The archaic empire MARX'S "ASIATIC FORMATION"	Evolved States EMPIRES, CITIES, FEUDAL SYSTEMS, MONARCHIES	Nation-States MODELS OF REALIZATION OF THE AXIOMATIC
Where is it found?	Egypt, Mesopotamia, the Indus valley, China, and "not only in Asia, but also in Africa, America, Greece, Rome" 427, 450	Rome's empire (with its consilium and fiscus), the Aegean cities, feudal systems, and absolute monarchy 451-52, 459	Modern nation-States of every kind (democratic, totalitarian, liberal, tyrannical), as well as the bureaucratic socialist States 455-56, 459
What does it do with flows?	It **overcodes** flows already coded by the communities it rules 427-28, 459	It organizes "qualified or topical conjunctions of decoded flows" 451, 459	It realizes "a general conjugation of flows," the capitalist axiomatic 454-55, 459
What is its regime of signs?	Overcoding, "or the Signifier" 428	Processes of **subjectification** 451	The **axiomatic**, which deals "directly with purely functional elements and relations" 454
What binds a collective?	The nexum, "the objective, imperial collective bond" 428, 460	Personal bonds, from contracts between owners to the conventions that tie the owned to their owners 451	"The Subject that binds itself," a contract "between self and self" 460
	One moment of the State through all its forms: "capture, bond, knot, nexum, magical capture" 460		
What becomes of property?	Everything is public, with the despot as "the sole and transcendent public-property owner" and land that cannot be sold 428	The public sphere becomes "the shared means for a now private appropriation" 451	Property is in "convertible abstract rights," and capital is itself "a right" 453-54
What is the form of its law?	"The overcoding of customs" 453	"A set of topics," subjective and conjunctive (Roman law, cf. Veyne) 451, 453	The form of an axiomatic, as in the French civil code (cf. Ray) 453
How are persons captured?	Machinic **enslavement**, "generalized slavery" in the megamachine (cf. Mumford) 428, 457	**Subjection**: ancient slavery and feudal serfdom were already "procedures of subjection" 457	Social subjection of the "naked" or "free" worker, joined by a new enslavement in cybernetic "humans-machines systems" 457-58
	"A small amount of subjectification took us away from machinic enslavement, but a large amount brings us back to it" 458		
What kind of surplus value?	Surplus value "of code" 451	Surplus value "of flow," first among the Aegean merchants and smiths 450-51	Surplus value that "becomes machinic" with automation 458
What does it do with the war machine?	It has none of its own, working instead through police and prisons while encasting warriors captured from outside 418, 425	Appropriation proper, as in the hoplite reform's army of citizen-soldiers 419, 426	Total war, then a worldwide war machine "of which they are no longer anything more than the opposable or apposed parts" 421, 466-67
How diverse is it?	"Little diversity, due to a certain formal immutability" 459	"Extremely diverse" 459	A diversity that is "a function of isomorphy," and of heteromorphy or polymorphy 459, 464-66
What escapes it?	Decoded flows of labor and money, and private property "slipping through the net," carried by "the collective figure of the Outsider" (freed slaves, cf. Tökei) 449	Decoded flows that "draw capitalism in negative outline" but are not let "stream together" 452	Minorities as nondenumerable sets, and "undecidable propositions" 470-73
	The Aegean "presuppose[s]" the oriental stock, and "there is always an empire on the horizon" 459-60		
		"Capitalism was continually being born, disappearing and reviving at every crossroads of history" 460	
How do the forms meet?	"Capitalism has reawakened the Urstaat, and given it new strength." The modern States "restore the most absolute of empires, a new 'megamachine,' whatever the novelty or timeliness of its now immanent form" 460		

Page numbers refer to the Minnesota translation of *A Thousand Plateaus* (1987). Bold type marks the two terms of a contrast. Brackets mark relations between the forms, dotted where they pass over a column. The three forms are worked out at length in the 1979-80 seminar, sessions 2 and 6-8, and the axiomatic in sessions 8-13 (listed on the back page of the library sheet).

The axiomatic today: seven points

In the present, as D&G see it, "capitalism and present-day politics are an axiomatic in the literal sense," which is why "nothing is played out in advance" (461). They set out "a summary sketch of the 'givens'" in seven parts. The last column records what, by their own account, each one leaves open to struggle.

Given	ATP	What Deleuze and Guattari say	What it leaves open to struggle
1. Addition, subtraction	461-63	Axioms are "operative statements." Social democracy adds them (Keynes and the New Deal as "axiom laboratories"), totalitarianism subtracts them, as in "the minimum State of anarcho-capitalism (cf. Chile)"	"It would be an error to take a disinterested stance toward struggle on the level of the axioms" 463
2. Saturation	463-64	Capitalism "has no laws but immanent ones." It confronts its own limits and displaces them at once (oil, nuclear power)	Local struggles must "directly target national and international axioms, at the precise point of their insertion" 464
3. Models, isomorphy	464-66	All States are models of realization: isomorphic at the center, heteromorphic in the socialist East, polymorphic at the periphery	It "would be absurd" to think popular movements condemned in advance, or all States "equivalent and homogeneous" 466
4. Power	466-67	A "power of the continuum" in the military-industrial complexes, where "peace … technologically frees the unlimited material process of total war"	The same capital "continually recreate[s] unexpected possibilities for counterattack" 422
5. The included middle	468-69	The center needs a periphery, and "internal Third Worlds" rise inside the center, with labor split between intensive surplus labor and "erratic" work	Negri's "internal margin," which "tends increasingly to merge the students with the emarginati" 469
6. Minorities	469-71	Minorities (not a demographic count but a fuzzy set) are nondenumerable sets, which States answer by "translating the minorities into denumerable sets or subsets"	The demand "to formulate their problems themselves" is what the axiomatic "cannot tolerate" 471
7. Undecidable propositions	471-73	Not "the uncertainty of the results" but "the coexistence and inseparability" of what the system conjugates and what escapes it	"The germ and locus par excellence of revolutionary decisions" 473

Poles of the capitalist State			
	Social democracy Adds axioms by organizing a domestic market and multiplying "directing axioms" 462	**Totalitarianism** Subtracts axioms and promotes the foreign sector, "the minimum State," with the population "a consequence" 462	**Fascism** A war economy and "a multiplication by subtraction," a "suicidal" State more than a totalitarian one (cf. Virilio) 462-63, 467

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